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MEDICAL EXAMINER — SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

Case #: 26-014872 **ME File #:** ME-26-0331 **Decedent:** Marcus HALE, DOB 11/02/1996 (age 29) **Examiner:** Dr. Priya ANAND, M.D., Forensic Pathologist **Date of Examination:** March 16, 2026

CAUSE AND MANNER

Cause of death: Two gunshot wounds of the torso. **Manner of death:** Homicide (medical/forensic classification; not a legal conclusion).

GUNSHOT WOUNDS

Wound A — chest. Entrance on the anterior (front) chest. Path proceeds **front-to-back and slightly upward**, with minor right-to-left deviation. Perforation of the heart and great vessels.

Wound B — upper abdomen. Entrance on the anterior (front) abdomen. Path proceeds **front-to-back and slightly upward**. Perforation of the liver.

Both wound tracks share a similar orientation: entering the front of the body and traveling **upward** through it.

RANGE OF FIRE

Examination of both entrance wounds found **no soot and no stippling (no gunpowder tattooing)** on the skin or clothing margins. These findings are **inconsistent with a contact or near-contact shot** and indicate the muzzle was beyond close range — generally **greater than approximately 3–4 feet** from the body at the time of discharge.

FORENSIC INTERPRETATION (limited)

- The **upward, front-to-back trajectories** are consistent with the decedent's torso being **inclined or leaning forward** toward the shooter at the

moment of discharge (for example, lunging or advancing). They are **less consistent** with an upright individual standing still or stepping backward.

- The **absence of soot/stippling** is consistent with a distance of more than a few feet between muzzle and decedent.
- These are physical findings only. Determinations regarding intent, threat, or justification are outside the scope of this report.

TOXICOLOGY

Pending. Preliminary field information indicated the decedent had been consuming alcohol; quantitative results to follow under separate cover.

— Priya Anand, M.D.